



PCI Express CPRI Board

Version: 2026-06-12

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1 Features

- CPRI line bit rate option 3,4,5 and 7 (bandwidth are 4, 5, 8 and 16 multiple of 614.4 Mbps)
- Suitable for up to four 2T2R (or two 4T4R) 20 MHz LTE cells
- Support for one 4T4R 100MHz NR(5G) cell with optionnal proprietary IQ compression
- Support input sample rate of 3.84, 7.68, 15.36, 23.04, 30.72, or 122.88 Msp/s
- 15 bits sample width
- Fast C&M support via Ethernet TUN interface
- Easy-to-add vendor specific information in CPRI control word
- Full support of mapping method 1 (contiguous)
- Support of mapping method 3 (interleaved) for a single cell only

Some hardware constraints apply:

- The two top SFP connector (port 0 and port 1) can support all line bit rates.
- The two bottom ports (port 2 and port 3) are limited to line rate 5 (mult 8)
- All SFP ports must use the same line bit rate
- Total combined bandwidth cannot exceed 10Gb/s

Possible combinations examples are:

- line rate 7 (mult 16) on port 0 for 4T4R 100MHz NR with compression
- line rate 5 (mult 8) on ports 0 and 1 for 2x 4T4R 20MHz LTE
- line rate 3 (mult 4) on ports 0, 1, 2 and 3

2 Installation with the Amarisoft software

2.1 Introduction

Amarisoft PCIe CPRI board uses the same driver as the Amarisoft PCIe SDR board. So you don't need to install anything if you already have a setup running with the SDR boards. Note that you can have SDR and CPRI boards plugged in the same PC. Board type is recognized automatically by the driver.

If you have bought the OTS (Off-The-Shelf) package, then you don't need to install anything. Everything has already been installed on your PC. Otherwise, please follow through the steps below.

Decompress the `trx_sdr` archive into a convenient directory specified by `<trx_path>`.

```
tar -xzf trx_sdr-linux-YYYY-MM-DD.tar.gz -C <trx_path>
```

You have two ways to install the TRX driver for the PCIe card:

- automatic
- manual

For both cases, the installation requires some specific packages to compile the kernel module. To do this, you need to be root. In Fedora and Cent OS, you need to install *kernel-devel*, *make*, *gcc* and *elfutils-libelf-devel* packages by running the following command:

```
dnf install kernel-devel-$(uname -r) make gcc elfutils-libelf-devel
```

For Ubuntu, use the following command:

```
apt-get install $(uname -a | awk '{print $3}') build-essential
```

Note that you'll need equivalent packages for other Linux distributions if you do not use Fedora, Ubuntu or Cent OS.

Once you have finished the installation, you need to initialize (See [Driver initialization], page 3) and upgrade your driver (See [Firmware upgrade], page 3). Please make sure to initialize the driver after each system boot if you have not activated an automatic lte service.

2.2 Automatic Installation

Automatic installation is only available on Fedora, Ubuntu and CentOS distributions. Use manual install for other distributions. To start your automatic install, use the following command where `<path>` is the path to the directory where you have already installed your LTE component (eNB or UE) and `type` should be set to `enb` or `ue` accordingly.

```
./install <path> <type>
```

Notes:

- the script would install some packages, so make sure you have root privileges when you run the script
- this install creates a symlink for the TRX driver so please do not remove this directory afterwards.

2.3 Manual Installation

To manually install the driver, let's note `<path>` the directory where Amarisoft eNB or UE software is installed. Then:

1. Compile kernel driver:

Go to the `kernel/` directory under `<trx_path>` and start compilation:

```
cd kernel
make
```

2. Place driver:

Just copy the compiled driver into `<path>` directory

```
cd ..
cp trx_sdr.so <path>
cp libsdr.so <path>
```

3. Config files:

Copy RF driver config file. Note that there are 2 separate config directories for eNB and UE called `config.enb` and `config.ue` under your `<trx_path>`. As a result, the `<config_dir>` should be set to `config.enb` or `config.ue` accordingly.

```
cp -r <config_dir> <path>/config/sdr
```

Select frontend:

```
<path>/config/rf_select.sh sdr
```

2.4 Driver initialization

Each time you boot your system, you need to perform this initialization. Note that if you are using OTS install, this step is already done by the lte service.

```
cd kernel
./init.sh
```

2.5 Firmware upgrade

Perform the following command to upgrade your PCIe card:

```
./sdr_util upgrade
```

Notes:

- If you have several PCIe cards installed, this will upgrade all cards.
- If the firmware is already up to date, this command will end directly.
- When the upgrade is over, you need your system to be powered off for the changes to take effect (not only reset, real power off).

2.6 Multiple card installation

Several CPRI boards can be installed on a same PC and functions independently

When you install several CPRI cards, the mapping between the PCI connectors and the Linux devices is not predictable (but it shouldn't change after each boot). To identify the order please do the following:

```
./sdr_util -c 0 led 1
```

Then check inside PC on each board, one of them should have a led blinking. This is card 0 (`/dev/sdr0`).

Switch off the led:

```
./sdr_util -c 0 led 0
```

You can do the same for other cards:

```
./sdr_util -c <n> led 1
```

Where `<n>` is the index of the card.

3 TRX driver configuration options

3.1 Single card configuration

The following properties are available:

name	String. Set the driver to use, always set "sdr" to use Amarisoft driver.
args	String. Set the system device names for the boards. Example: args : "dev0=/dev/sdr0" args : "dev0=/dev/sdr0,dev1=/dev/sdr2"
sync	Optional enumeration: none, gps, external, cpri (default = none). Set the time synchronization source. none uses the internal PPS generated from the clock. gps uses the GPS synchronization when a GPS antenna is connected to the GPS port. external uses the PPS from the CLK IN connector (CN7 on Figure 8.1). cpri synchronizes itself with the CPRI frame received in the SFP port, to be used when the board behaves in 'slave' or RE mode. When several cards are selected (with the args property), sync only sets the time synchronization source of the first card. The other cards are implicitly set to external synchronization, assuming the previous card is used as source.
clock	Optional enumeration: internal, external (default = internal). Set the clock source. internal uses the internal clock (VCTCXO). If an external PPS sync source is used, the internal clock frequency is adjusted by the PPS signal. external uses the clock from the CLK IN connector (CN7 on Figure 8.1).
cpri_mult	Integer. Select the CPRI line bit rate in terms of multiple of option 1 (614.4 Mbps). E.g set 4 for option 3, 8 for option 5 and 16 for option 7. Use comma separated list for multiple card configuration ([Multiple card configuration], page 6). cpri_mult and cpri_option are mutually exclusive.
cpri_option	String or integer. Select the CPRI line bit rate based on CPRI option. Use comma separated list for multiple card configuration ([Multiple card configuration], page 6). cpri_mult and cpri_option are mutually exclusive.
cpri_mapping	Optional enumeration: standard, hw, spread (default = standard) Selects the mapping method. (Sample mode, 15 bits per I or Q). standard is mapping method 1 (all AxC are contiguous). hw is method 1 with offloads onto the board hardware. spread is mapping method 3 (AxC are interleaved). Note that spread mapping is only partially supported. Use comma separated list for multiple card configuration ([Multiple card configuration], page 6).
fast_cm_pointer	Optional integer (default = 54). Range 20-63. Value of the 'p' pointer (control word #194) defining the start subchannel of the fast C&M channel which will span subchannels p to 63. Use comma separated list for multiple card configuration ([Multiple card configuration], page 6).

- ifname** String. Interface name of the TUN interface connected to the fast C&M channel. Use comma separated list for multiple card configuration ([Multiple card configuration], page 6).
- vss_data** Optional string to configure vendor specific data in the CPRI control word Format is string of pipe | separated items of the form X:data where X is the control word index $X = N_s + 64 * X_s$ and data is a hex string of length equals to the CPRI line multiplier. The first byte in the string corresponds to byte 0 in the CPRI frame, the second byte to byte 1, etc. If data is smaller than the CPRI multiplier, it will be right-padded with 0. Example for a CPRI multiplier of 16 (option 7, 9830.4 Mbps) to write a full data at index 16 and a single byte at index 80 : **vss_data** : "16:0123456789ABCDEF0123456789ABCDEF|80:FF" . Note that any vendor specific data overlapping with the fast C&M channel will be overwritten by the Ethernet data. Use comma separated list for multiple card configuration ([Multiple card configuration], page 6).
- cpri_rx_delay** Optional floating point value in microseconds (default 0). Delay between TX and RX position in CPRI frame. This should be set to the value of (T2a + T3a - Toffset) provided by the RRH specification. Check [Delay management], page 8, for more details. Use comma separated list for multiple card configuration ([Multiple card configuration], page 6).
- cpri_tx_delay** Optional floating point value in microseconds (default 0). Advance Start of Frame relative to PPS to compensate for delays in transmit line and RRH. This should be set to T12 + T2a. Check [Delay management], page 8, for more details. Use comma separated list for multiple card configuration ([Multiple card configuration], page 6).
- cpri_tx_dbm** Optional floating point value in dBm (default 0). Needed by ENB/GNB to have a notion of actual output power. Computed from maximum power output of the RRH for a 0dBFS input signal (full scale). You need to take into account the loss in RF cables and efficiency of antennas. Exemple: RRH spec is 5Watt for -14dBFS input, so: +37dBm for -14dBFS: tx_gain = +51dB gain. In this case, parameter **cpri_tx_dbm** could be set to 51.0, but actual value for best performance was 42.0. Use comma separated list for multiple card configuration ([Multiple card configuration], page 6).
- cpri_rx_dbm** Optional floating point value in dBm (default 0). Needed by ENB/GNB to have a notion of actual received power. Computed from analog input power of the RRH for a 0dBFS digital level (full scale). You need to take into account the loss in RF cables and efficiency of antennas. Exemple: RRH spec is -40dBm for 0dBFS input, so: rx_gain = +40dB gain. In this case, parameter **cpri_rx_dbm** could be set to 40.0, but actual value for best performance maybe slightly lower. Use comma separated list for multiple card configuration ([Multiple card configuration], page 6).
- tx_subch_dump_file** Optional string. If present, the control words of the sent CPRI hyperframes are dumped to the file specified by the parameter, in binary format. The control word

of each hyperframe consists in 256 words of `cpri_mult` bytes. The words of the control channel are dumped by increasing number of subchannels, i.e with the index in the following order 0, 64, 128, 192, 1, 65, ... To spare CPU resources, only one every 16 hyperframes is dumped to the file. The file begins with a four bytes header : 0x43 0x50 0x90 <`cpri_mult`>. Due to the rapidly increasing file size, it is strongly recommended to use this parameter only for a short duration and for debug purposes.

Use comma separated list for multiple card configuration ([Multiple card configuration], page 6).

`rx_subch_dump_file`

Optional string. If present, the control words of the received CPRI hyperframes are dumped to the file specified by the parameter. The file has the same structure than `tx_subch_dump_file`

Use comma separated list for multiple card configuration ([Multiple card configuration], page 6).

`eth_preamble_size`

Optional integer (default 7). Number of bytes of the Ethernet preamble for Fast C&M channel. Minimum size is 2 (preamble is then 0x55 0xd5). Maximum size is 7 (0x55 0x55 0x55 0x55 0x55 0x55 0xd5).

Use comma separated list for multiple card configuration ([Multiple card configuration], page 6).

`cpri_hook`

Optional string. If set defines the CPRI hook shared library to use (cf `api/cpri_hook.c` for example).

Use comma separated list for multiple card configuration ([Multiple card configuration], page 6).

`cpri_hook_data`

Optional string. If set, will be passed to CPRI hooks as user data.

Use comma separated list for multiple card configuration ([Multiple card configuration], page 6).

`cpri_debug`

Optional integer (default = 0). If positive, debug information will be displayed in terminal

`cpri_sample_offset`

Optional string. List of integers separated by `:`. Each integer defines the position in bits of channel IQ samples inside basic frames.

`dev_ref_ports`

Optional integer (default = 1). Defines how many TRX RF ports to map to this device.

You may use `cpri_sample_offset` to manually set IQ samples position within CPRI hyperframe.

`rx_chan_mapping`

Optional string. By default, if the radio frontend has more RX channels available than configured (ex: more physical RX connectors on SDR or more channels in CPRI hyperframes), the driver uses the first channels of the radio frontend.

This parameter allows to select the RX channels of the radio frontend to use.

This parameter is a list of number (must have as many number as RF port configuration) separated by colons. Each number represents the RX channel of the radio frontend to use.

3.2 Multiple card configuration

All single card configuration parameters apply to multiple card mode.

To differentiate configuration for each card, the syntax of some parameter will change to a list of value separated by commas (,).* The first value will apply to the first board defined in **args** argument, ...

Example:

```
cpri_mult: "4,16"
```

Will mean dev0 will use CPRI speed 4 and dev1 will use CPRI speed 16

This syntax applies to the following parameters:

- cpri_mult
- cpri_option
- cpri_mapping
- fast_cm_pointer
- cpri_sample_offset
- vss_data
- cpri_debug
- cpri_tx_delay
- cpri_rx_delay
- cpri_tx_dbm
- cpri_rx_dbm
- tx_subch_dump_file
- rx_subch_dump_file
- eth_preamble_size
- ifname
- cpri_hook
- cpri_hook_data
- rx_chan_mapping

4 Time

4.1 Delay management

To configure delays and adjust propagation delays so that TX signal is aligned to PPS and RX is aligned to TX, you need to setup [cpri_tx_delay], page 5, and [cpri_rx_delay], page 5.

`cpri_tx_delay` is used to align TX signal to PPS.

The CPRI driver uses this value to start sending of hyperframes before its own PPS so that the associated signal reaches antenna at the correct time.

This delay should be set to $T_{12} + T_{2a}$

`cpri_rx_delay` is used to align TX and RX signal and ensure synchronization for TDD.

The CPRI driver use this value to apply an offset to the received signal inside the hyperframes to compensate propagation delay and align RX to TX. When the CPRI driver receives an hyperframe, it uses its HFN/BFN to compute the timestamp of the signal and removes the `cpri_rx_delay`.

This delay should be set to $T_{2a} + T_{3a} - \text{Toffset}$

Example:

The BBU generates the signal at $t=0$ (Ex: start of a frame).

The signal is put in HFR:0.0 (HFN=0, BFN=0) and is sent to RRU at $t=-(T_{12} + T_{2a})$

HFR:0.0 reaches R2 at $t=-T_{2a}$

HFR:0.0 reaches antenna at $t=0$ as expected

The RRU generates HFR:0.0 at $t=-T_{2a} + \text{Toffset}$ as it aligns on received

HFR:0.0 at $t=-T_{2a}$.

The signal put in HFR:0.0 is the one received $-T_{3a}$ earlier at antenna side.

Which means that HFR:0.0 sent by RRU is filled with signal received at antenna side at $t=-T_{2a} + \text{Toffset} - T_{3a}$.

4.2 GPS usage

You can check the GPS operation when the eNodeB/UE is stopped with

```
./sdr_util gps_state
```

The GPS takes a few minutes to lock if the GPS antenna is connected. Any active GPS antenna accepting a 3.3V DC supply can be used, for example: <http://www.mouser.fr/Search/ProductDetail.aspx?R=ANT-GPS-SH-SMAvirtualkey59000000virtualkey712-ANT-GPS-SH-SMA>

To ensure the PLL is correctly locked when launching the lte software, it is recommended to set the synchro to GPS beforehand with the command

```
./sdr_util sync_gps
```

4.3 Oscillator frequency fine tuning

If you don't have a GPS, it is still possible to manually fine tune the VCTCXO (Voltage Controlled, Temperature Controlled Crystal Oscillator) frequency provided you have a way to know the offset:

```
./sdr_util clock_tune n
```

where n is the offset in PPM (parts-per-million) from the nominal TCXO frequency. Note: the PPM offset n to voltage law is only approximative, so you should adjust it by successive approximation.

5 CPRI in practice

We recommend to take a look at this tutorial (https://tech-academy.amarisoft.com/CPRI_RRH.html) to learn more about CPRI.

We also recommend to set `cpri_debug` to 1 in your configuration file. It will give you useful information about cpri mapping.

Ex:

```
### CPRI initialization ###
Speed:           x4
Channels:        2
Bits per samples: 30
Hardware mapping: on
Ethernet:
  Speed:         10
  Buffer size:   131072
  Preamble size: 7
RF port 0:
  Channels:      2
  Offset bits:   360 420
  Samples/chan:  2 (120 bits)
  Use HW mapping
Mapping:
  Channel 0.0:   360 => 420
  Channel 0.1:   420 => 480
  120/480 bites used
```

6 Miscellaneous utilities

6.1 sdr_util

usage: sdr_util [options] cmd [args...]

Options:

-h	help
-c device_num	select the device (default = all)

Available commands:

version	dump the FPGA version
sync_state	dump the synchro and clock state
gps_state	dump the GPS state
sync_gps	select GPS as sync source, wait for stable state
gps_cal [-s]	uses the GPS sync to tune VCXO, optionnaly stores the value
temp	dump the temperature of the board components
led [0 1]	enable/disable led blinking
clock_tune n	tune TCXO frequency offset to n ppm
upgrade [options]	upgrade the FPGA firmware
upgrade options are:	
-force	force upgrade even if identical or previous version

7 C API

The PCIe CPRI board can be used in other projects with its C API. The C API allows to send and receive I/Q samples and to change the various parameters (frequency, sample rate, bandwidth, gains, ...). The Amarisoft TRX driver, `sdr_play` and `sdr_spectrum` are built using this API.

The C API is described in `libsdr.h`. The corresponding Linux x86_64 dynamic library is `libsdr.so`.

Amarisoft does not provide any support for this API and can modify it without notice.

8 Physical specifications

8.1 Summary

- 4 SFP ports to connect REs through optical or Ethernet cabling. (See Features for constraints).
- 1 SMA female (GPS antenna with 3.3V DC power supply)
- 2 SATA connectors to share Clock and Sync signals between CPRI boards (CN6, CN7)
- A yellow led on the top edge of the board for identification
- PCIe 4x lanes gen 2.
- Uses single 12V power supply from PCI connector (with 2A Fuse)
- Frequency Accuracy: 2 ppm
- Full size (L x W x H): 128mm x 180mm x 20mm
- Weight: 0.200 kg

8.2 Connectors

The following figure depicts the location and functionality of each connector in the PCIe board.

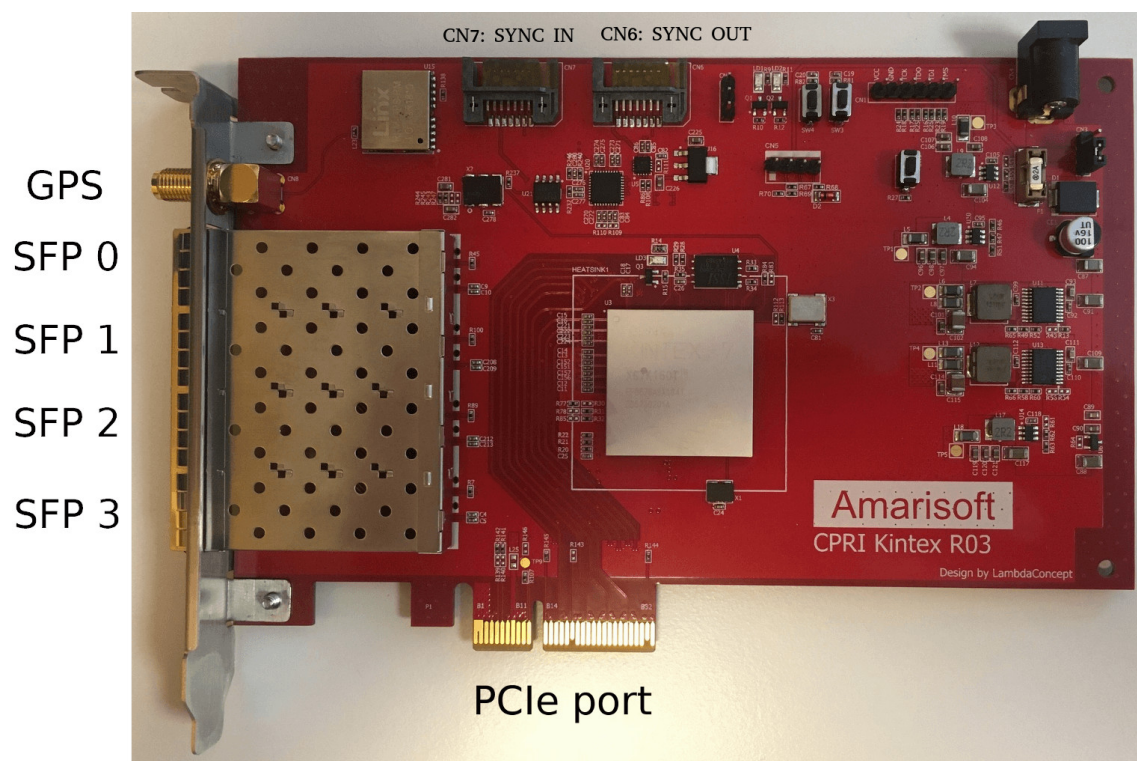


Figure 8.1

8.2.1 PPS/Clock connectors

Clock sync connectors

CN7 CLK_IN Input to sync this board as slave.

CN6 CLK_OUT Output to use this board as master for other CPRI board

On each SATA connector:

pin 1,4,7 GND

pin 2,3 AC coupled LVDS 122.88MHz clock

pin 5,6 DC coupled CMOS (3V3) Pulse per Second signal 6=positive side

9 Remote API

SDR driver implements the `trx` remote API.

Message definition:

`command` Optional string. Can be:

- `clock_tune`
- `cpri_rx_delay`
- `cpri_tx_delay`

Example:

```
{
  "message": "trx",
  "command": "clock_tune"
}
```

Here are the additional request and response field depending on `command` value:

9.1 `clock_tune`

Request fields:

`offset` Optional number. If `command` is `clock_tune`, defines the clock drift to set in ppm.

9.2 `cpri_rx_delay`

Request fields:

`rf_port` Integer. Defines RF port to set and/or get.

`cpri_rx_delay`

Optional number. Update `[cpri_rx_delay]`, page 5, in microseconds.

Response fields:

`cpri_rx_delay`

Current `[cpri_rx_delay]`, page 5, in microseconds

9.3 `cpri_tx_delay`

Request fields:

`rf_port` Integer. Defines RF port to set and/or get.

`cpri_tx_delay`

Optional number. Update `[cpri_tx_delay]`, page 5, in microseconds

Response fields:

`cpri_tx_delay`

Current `[cpri_tx_delay]`, page 5, in microseconds. Note that the delay with PPS won't be affected. This will only affect the IQ signal inside CPRI frames.

10 Change history

10.1 Version 2025-12-12

- Added `dev_ref_ports` configuration parameter

10.2 Version 2025-06-13

- Added `rx_chan_mapping` configuration parameter

10.3 Version 2024-09-13

- Added `cpri_rx_dbm` parameter

10.4 Version 2024-06-14

- Added remote API support

10.5 Version 2023-09-08

- Added NUMA support